❖ Vitamin and mineral deficiency diseases

Certain diseases are caused by deficiency of vitamins and minerals. By eating vitamin and mineral rich food items, we can avoid these diseases. The following table gives some of the diseases caused by deficiency of vitamins and minerals and the food items which rectify them.

Name of the Vitamin/Mineral	Name of the disease	Food containing the Vitamin/Mineral
Vitamin –A	Night blindness	Egg, Milk, Carrot, Papaya
Vitamin –B	Beri beri	Milk, Peas, Cereals, Green vegetables
Vitamin –C	Scurvy	Amla, Orange, Lemon, Tomato
Vitamin –D	Rickets	Sunlight, Milk, Egg, Fish
Vitamin –E	Sterility	Apple, Wheat, Green vegetables
Vitamin –K	Haemorrhage	Green vegetables, Tomato, Cabbage
Iodine	Goitre	Iodized salt, Vegetables
Iron	Anaemia	Cashews, Beans and lentils, Spinach



V. Food Pyramid

Food pyramid is designed to make healthy eating. Depending upon our work, age and sex, the requirement of various nutrients vary from person to person. For example, growing children need more proteins in their food. People doing hard physical work (labour) needs more carbohydrate and fats in their diet. Eating healthy breakfast helps to improve concentration and it boosts metabolism.

Balanced diet: The food we normally eat in a day is our diet. For growth and maintenance of good health, our diet should have all the nutrients that our body needs, in right quantities. Such a diet is called balanced diet. Pulses, groundnut, soya beans, sprouted seeds, fermented foods, banana, jaggery, seasonal vegetables and fruits provide more nutrients. Therefore, one can have a balanced diet without much expenditure. Some major food items are given in the table below.

Major Food Items	Sources
Carbohydrates	Honey, Sugarcane, Fruits, Whole grains, Vegetables, Rice
Proteins	Legumes, Pulses, Nuts, Soya bean, Green leafy vegetables, Fish, Egg, Milk
Fats	Egg yolk, Saturated oil, Meat

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